



TIPS & TRICKS

How to check the date and time the system was rebooted



Here is a simple command to check the system's reboot date and time:

```
#last reboot
```

```
reboot    system boot  2.6.18-53.el5   Sat Aug  6 18:02
(8+04:45)
wtmp begins Sat Aug  6 18:02:07 2011
```

The command below will give you the date and time the system was booted:

```
#who -b
```

```
system boot  2011-08-24 09:43
```

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Reloading XWindows System



Sometimes, while working on a Linux-based computer, XWindows System doesn't respond very well. Here are the steps to reload XWindows System in a non-responsive Ubuntu system.

1. First open the command mode by pressing: Ctrl + Alt + F2 ...and then entering your username and password.
2. Then run the following command:

```
top
```

Search the process named 'Xorg' in the list.

If it does not appear, wait for a few seconds. Then find the PID of the 'Xorg' process, listed at the extreme left of the output on the top.

You can also get the PID using the command given below:

```
pgrep Xorg
```

3. Now run the following command to kill the Xorg process:

```
sudo kill "PID"
```

...where PID is the process ID of Xorg.
This will reload the XWindows System.



Note: You must have root access to use these commands

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Handling log files



As developers, we do a lot of testing after coding the software and we frequently need to handle the log files to identify the errors in the code of an application program. Given below are the steps to handle various log files that are being generated on a Linux system.

1. Clearing a log/text file:

```
$ >filename
```

The above command will clear all contents of the file.

2. To view the log/text file:

```
$ tail -f filename
```

This command will display the file contents as and when the log is written. It also displays the flow of the log.

3. To use more sophisticated tools on log files:

```
$ less filename
```

This will display the log file contents. You can also use the commands below while using *less*.

- a. To refresh the log automatically, press:

```
o f
```

after issuing the *less* command.